

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Trump: US to 'run' Venezuela

MADURO, WIFE CAPTURED OVERNIGHT ON MILITARY BASE AND BROUGHT TO NEW YORK



Venezuelans living in Chile celebrate in Santiago on Saturday after U.S. forces captured Venezuelan leader Nicolas Maduro. JAVIER TORRES/GETTY-AFP

President plans to sell 'large amounts' of the nation's oil to other countries

By Regina Garcia Cano, Konstantin Toropin and Eric Tucker
Associated Press

CARACAS, Venezuela — The United States captured Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro and flew him out of the country in an extraordinary military operation early Saturday that plucked a sitting leader from office.

Hours after the military operation, President Donald Trump said the United States would run Venezuela at least temporarily and tap its vast oil reserves to sell to other

nations.

The dramatic action capped an intensive Trump administration pressure campaign on the South American nation and its autocratic leader and months of secret planning resulting in the most assertive American action to achieve regime change since the 2003 invasion of Iraq.

Speaking to reporters hours after Maduro's capture, Trump revealed his plans to exploit the leadership void to "fix" the country's oil infrastructure and sell "large amounts" of oil to other countries.



Maduro



Flores

a narco-terrorism conspiracy. A plane carrying the deposed leader landed Saturday evening near New York City. Maduro was later taken to a federal facility in the city.

Venezuela's vice president demanded that the U.S. free Maduro and called him the country's rightful leader.

The legal authority for the operation was not clear, though the Trump administration described it — and earlier deadly strikes on boats in the Caribbean Sea — as necessary to stem the flow of

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INSIDE

Trump lays out details of attack

The operation termed "Absolute Resolve" unfolded under the cover of darkness, with U.S. forces waiting for ideal weather conditions to give pilots clear routes into Caracas. **Nation & World**

RISKY MISSION: Operation comes with payoff and rocky path ahead. **Nation & World**

IN ILLINOIS: Residents react with both hope and dread. **Chicagoland, Page 12**

'His mind is still incarcerated'

Illinois exonerees struggle without support after wrongful convictions

By Olivia Olander
Chicago Tribune

Paul Terry walked out of prison more than 20 years ago after DNA evidence cleared him of a crime he was convicted of as a teenager. He was free, but the life he lost has never returned.

Now 67, Terry rarely speaks. He spends much of his time confining himself to his bedroom inside a South Side home he shares with his family, still grappling with mental health issues he developed behind bars.

"It has been devastating to see my brother the way he is, because when he went to prison, he wasn't like that," said his eldest sister, Doris Johnson, 84. "His mind is still incarcerated."

Terry's struggle is a stark example of a problem Illinois has yet to confront meaningfully: what happens to people after the state's judicial system admits it wrongfully took their freedom.



For the better part of a decade, Illinois led the nation in annual exonerations until it was surpassed by Texas in 2024, according to the National Registry of Exonerations. Yet Illinois offers

Turn to Exonerees, Page 10

Paul Terry contemplates his freedom after 27 years as he's surrounded by family and media on May 23, 2003. Terry, who now lives with his sister and her family, developed mental illnesses in prison and has not been well since.

BILL HOGAN/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

OPERATION MIDWAY BLITZ

Cost of enforcement surge: \$59 million and counting

Estimate of operation's price tag amid criticism of lack of transparency

By Daniel C. Vock
Chicago Tribune

As the Trump administration steadily hypes the benefits it sees from its monthslong immigration enforcement surge in Illinois, federal officials have been less eager to address the other side of the ledger: the fiscal cost of Operation Midway Blitz.

Activists, Illinois Democrats in Congress and members of the public have repeatedly sought an accounting of the operation, only to see their requests repeatedly stonewalled. But a Tribune review of court filings, databases and other public records detailing the scope of the incursion and the typical costs of its compo-

nents begins to paint a clearer picture.

Since Midway Blitz began in early September, the federal government has spent at least \$59 million deploying and equipping federal personnel and detaining the roughly 4,500 people arrested by Immigration and Customs Enforcement and Border Patrol agents during that period, the Tribune found.

The analysis — a conservative, back-of-the-envelope estimate — offers one of the first examinations of the operation's price tag as criticism has escalated over the lack of transparency surrounding how it was conducted and its taxpayer cost.

"For months, the Trump administration has trampled over our Constitution and failed to answer even the most basic

Turn to Cost, Page 8

The year past, the year to come

David Bowie, delivery robots and Broadview: A period of uncertainty in Chicagoland offers a chance for poignant reflection. **Christopher Borrelli in A+E**

Exploring all of Chicago

A Roosevelt University graduate student has been working to become the first known person to run every single one of the city's streets. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

'He never changed his tune'

Bears coach Ben Johnson has come full circle since his Lions moment. Plus, finding edges in the running game fuels Johnson's evolution of the offense. **Chicago Sports**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 31 Low 29

Complete forecast on Opinion, Page 12

\$5.75 city and suburbs and elsewhere
178th year No. 4 © Chicago Tribune

